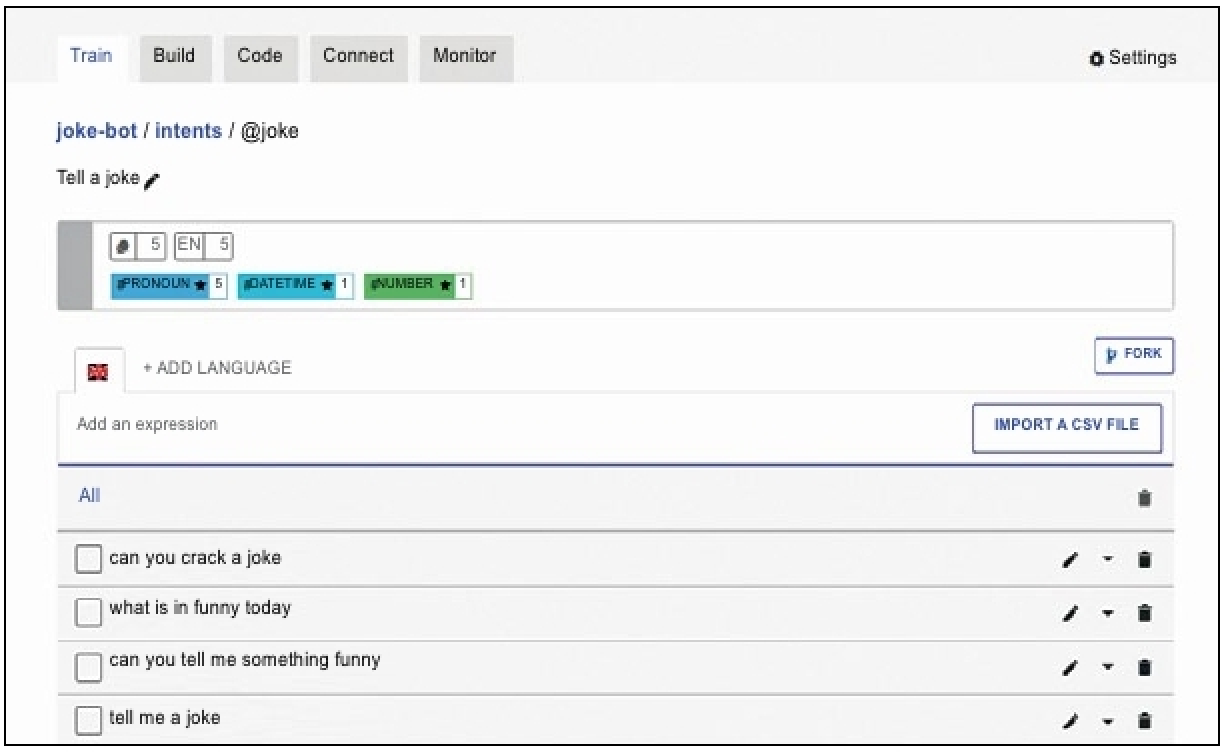

Fig. 6: Suggested expressions

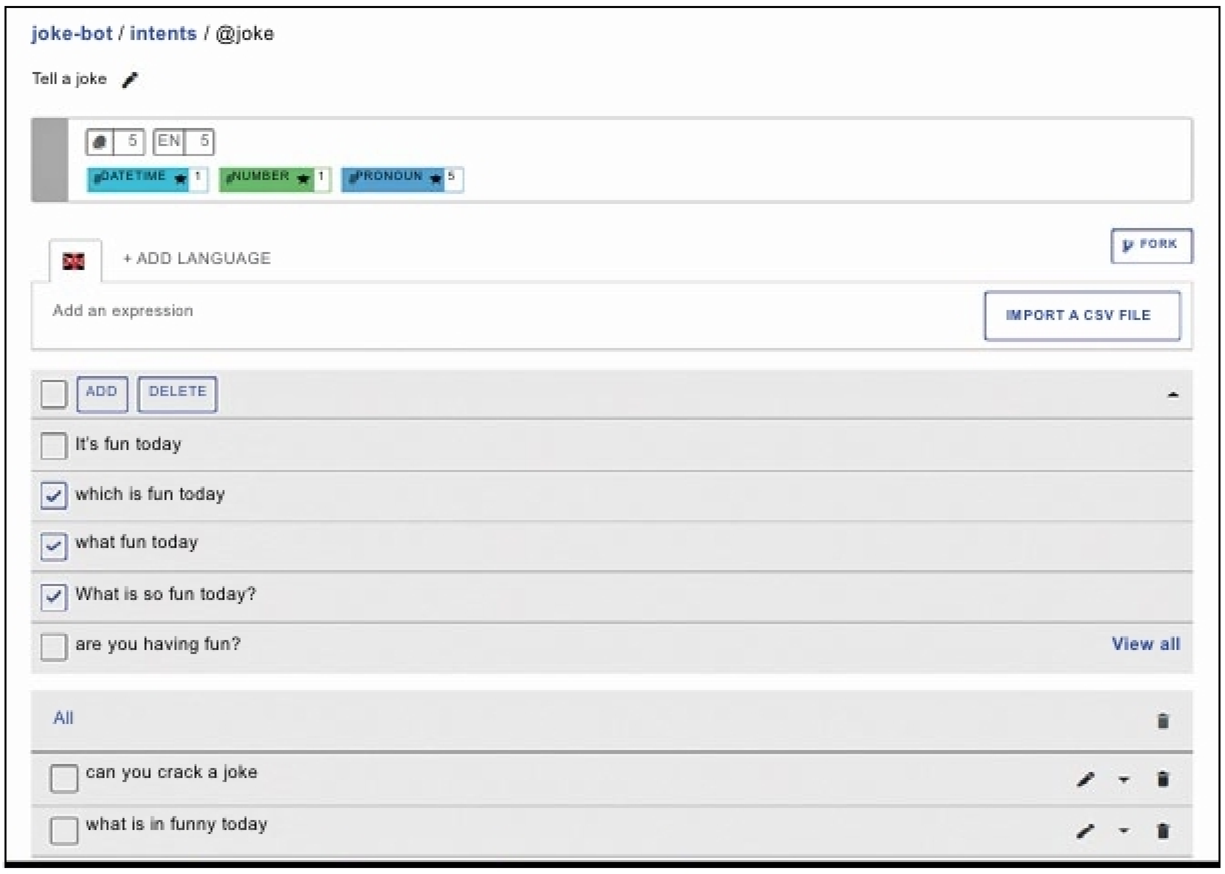

Fig. 7: Suggested expressions

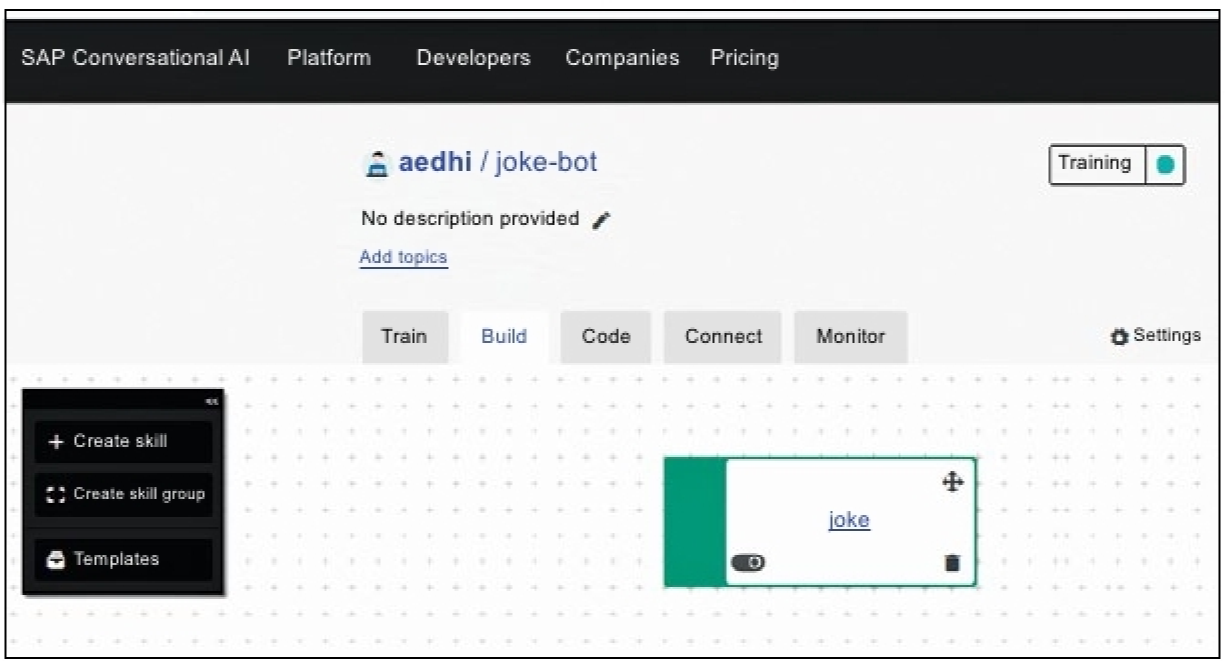

Fig. 8: Skills dashboard

"An intent is a box of expressions that mean the same thing but which are constructed in different ways. Intents are the heart of your bot's understanding. Each one of your intents represents an idea your bot is able to understand." (from the *Recast. AI* website)

As decided earlier, you need the bot to be able to crack jokes. So the base line is that the bot should be able to understand that the user is asking it to tell a joke; it shouldn't be that even when the user just says, "Hi," the bot responds with a joke—that would not be good.

So group the utterances that the user might make, like:

Tell me a joke.
Tell me a funny fact.
Can you crack a joke?
What's funny today?
....

Before going on to create the intent from scratch, let us explore the Search/fork option. Type Joke in the search field (Fig. 3). This gives a list of intents created by users of Recast around the globe, which is public, and this is why Recast is said to be collaborative in nature. So there's no need to create all intents from scratch; one can build upon intents already created. This brings down the effort needed to train the bot with common intents.

- Select the first intent in the list and fork it into the bot.
- Click on the Fork button. The intent is now added to the bot (Fig. 4).
- Click on the intent @joke, and a list of expressions which already exist in the intent will be displayed (Fig. 5).
- Add a few more expressions to it (Fig. 6).

Once a few expressions are added, the bot gives suggestions like shown in Fig. 7. Select a few and add them to the intent (Fig. 7).

You can also tag your own custom entities to detect keywords, depending on your bot's context.

Skills

A skill is a block of conversation that has a clear purpose and that your bot can execute to achieve a goal. It can be as simple as the ability to greet someone, but it can also be more complex, like giving movie suggestions based on information provided by the user.